Pirates

Freebooters and Fortune Hunters

Habitat: Any; **Treasure:** Individual, Implements

The term "pirate" encompasses a broad range of seafarers, including vicious sea rovers, dogged privateers, cursed treasure hunters, and others who seek riches and fame on the seas.

Pirates might be allies, foes, wild cards, or some combination thereof. While they are the bane of merchants and coastal communities, they know secrets of the sea and how to avoid aquatic threats. More unusual pirates set their sights beyond the waves, using airships, spelljamming vessels, plane-shifting craft, or stranger vehicles to explore and raid incredible realms.

Pirate

Along with being competent warriors, pirates are accomplished seafarers who know how to sail and maintain a ship. While some loyally follow their captains' orders, others place greed, superstition, or self-preservation over duty.

Pirate Captain

Pirate captains command crews of pirates, dictating their destinations and targets. Captains cultivate fearsome and theatrical reputations, painting themselves as larger-than-life characters to terrorize their foes, ensure the obedience of their crews, and attract followers to their banner. Many have colorful nicknames inspired by signature traits and deeds.

Pirate

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral

AC 14 **Initiative** +5 (15)
HP 33 (6d8 + 6)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	10	+0	+0	**Dex**	16	+3	+5	**Con**	12	+1	+1
Int	8	−1	−1	**Wis**	12	+1	+1	**Cha**	14	+2	+4

Gear Daggers (6), Leather Armor
Senses Passive Perception 11
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The pirate makes two Dagger attacks. It can replace one attack with a use of Enthralling Panache.

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) Piercing damage.

Enthralling Panache. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 12, one creature the pirate can see within 30 feet. *Failure:* The target has the Charmed condition until the start of the pirate's next turn.

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Pirate Admiral

Pirate admirals command whole pirate fleets. They undertake audacious ventures, such as challenging the navies of coastal nations, hunting legendary sea creatures, or carving out their own pirate kingdoms. Pirate admirals might launch their fleets from hidden fortresses where they hoard their treasure—or keep maps to where they've hidden their riches. Some pirate admirals ally with the followers of oceanic deities, underwater dwellers, and sea monsters, as well as their fellow scalawags.

Pirate Flags

To terrify opponents and spread their reputations, pirate crews fly distinctive flags. Roll twice on or choose results from the Pirate Flags table to inspire what flag a pirate crew sails under.

Pirate Flags

1d8	The Flag Shows A ...	1d8	With ...
1	Buccaneer	1	A captain's hat
2	Dragon	2	Crossbones
3	Fiend	3	Crossed blades
4	Goat	4	An eye patch
5	Kraken	5	Lightning bolts
6	Merfolk	6	A mug of ale
7	Skull	7	A tattoo
8	Whale	8	A treasure chest

Pirate Captain

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral

AC 17 **Initiative** +7 (17)
HP 84 (13d8 + 26)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	10	+0	+3	**Dex**	18	+4	+7	**Con**	14	+2	+2
Int	10	+0	+0	**Wis**	14	+2	+5	**Cha**	17	+3	+6

Skills Acrobatics +7, Perception +5
Gear Pistol, Rapier
Senses Passive Perception 15
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 6 (XP 2,300; PB +3)

Actions

Multiattack. The pirate makes three attacks, using Rapier or Pistol in any combination.

Rapier. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) Piercing damage, and the pirate has Advantage on the next attack roll it makes before the end of this turn.

Pistol. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +7, range 30/90 ft. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) Piercing damage.

Bonus Actions

Captain's Charm. *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 14, one creature the pirate can see within 30 feet. *Failure:* The target has the Charmed condition until the start of the pirate's next turn.

Reactions

Riposte. *Trigger:* The pirate is hit by a melee attack roll while holding a weapon. *Response:* The pirate adds 3 to its AC against that attack, possibly causing it to miss. On a miss, the pirate makes one Rapier attack against the triggering creature if within range.

Pirate Admiral

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral

AC 20 **Initiative** +10 (20)
HP 182 (28d8 + 56)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	14	+2	+6	**Dex**	22	+6	+10	**Con**	14	+2	+2
Int	12	+1	+1	**Wis**	14	+2	+6	**Cha**	19	+4	+8

Skills Acrobatics +10, Athletics +6, Perception +6
Gear Pistol, Scimitar
Senses Passive Perception 16
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 12 (XP 8,400; PB +4)

Actions

Multiattack. The pirate makes three attacks, using Scimitar or Pistol in any combination.

Scimitar. *Melee Attack Roll:* +10, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 16 (3d6 + 6) Slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) Poison damage, and the target suffers one of the following effects of the pirate's choice:

Awestruck. The target has the Charmed condition until the start of the pirate's next turn.

Poison. The target has the Poisoned condition until the start of the pirate's next turn.

Pistol. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +10, range 30/90 ft. *Hit:* 28 (4d10 + 6) Piercing damage.

Bonus Actions

Rally (1/Day). The pirate chooses up to three other creatures it can see within 30 feet. Until the start of the pirate's next turn, the targets have Advantage on attack rolls and saving throws.

Reactions

Defensive Stance. *Trigger:* The pirate is hit by a melee attack roll while holding a weapon. *Response:* The pirate adds 4 to its AC against melee attack rolls (including the triggering attack) until the start of its next turn, possibly causing the attacks to miss.